EXPERIENCE TRANSFORMATION STRATEGY

One portfolio. One experience.

A single program that unites portfolio discipline, application convergence, and a shared experience system, delivered as the user-facing half of Project MACH1.

Users do not experience applications. They experience work.

Adam Z. Stavely, Technical Director
October 2026 · Draft for leadership review

THE PROBLEM

Our users pay a hidden tax on every task.

Duplicate tools for the same job, so users must choose between them or use both.

Inconsistent interfaces that each have to be relearned.

Swivel-chair seams where data is re-keyed between systems.

No single place to learn what changed, what is next, or how to be heard.

Every application added without discipline raises that tax, and the cost to sustain it.

THE VISION

A user who has learned one of our applications already knows how to use all of them, moves work between them without friction, and always knows where to learn what changed, what is coming, and how to be heard.

FOUR PILLARS, ONE PROGRAM

A

Shape the portfolio

Prevent new sprawl with a decision ladder; reduce existing sprawl with a disposition process that converges, consolidates, and retires.

B

Unify the experience

One master brand, one universal header, one visual and interaction language delivered through the design system.

C

Carry the change

Standard portals, in-app guided tutorials, and a change track so every convergence lands as an improvement, not a disruption.

D

Govern and measure

Decisions made once, at AERB, enforced through paved roads, and judged by user outcomes first.

ONE EXECUTIVE NUMBER

Reduced cost of ownership per user, always reported beside user outcomes. A lower app count paired with worse task times is a failure.

02 · OPERATING MODEL

Three layers, two engines, one loop.

MACH1 builds what sits behind the glass. This strategy decides what users meet at the glass and how every product feels. Two engines move applications through the layers; a change track carries every move to users; measurement closes the loop.

ENGINE 1 · PREVENT

The decision ladder

Every new need walks down six rungs and stops at the first that works: configure, extend, compose, integrate, platform. A new application is the last rung.

Stops sprawl at the source →

ENGINE 2 · REDUCE

The disposition process

Every existing app gets one disposition through a ten-phase, wave-based process: retain, invest, integrate, federate, converge, consolidate, or retire.

Removes sprawl that exists →

Experience system

APPLIES TO EVERYTHING USERS TOUCH

- Design system and tokens
- Master brand and universal header
- Standard user portals
- In-app guided tutorials

The glass

WHAT USERS MEET

A few SuperApps, one per role or mission domain

Module | Module | Module

One entry point, navigation, search, identity, and data context. Fed by Federate and Consolidate dispositions.

Retained apps

Distinct jobs, standardized and integrated so work flows across them. Fed by Retain, Invest, Integrate.

Behind the glass · Project MACH1

FED BY CONVERGE

- Capability platforms
- AI orchestration layer
- Shared identity and data

CHANGE TRACK · CARRY

Every move reaches users as an improvement

Release notes, roadmap, feedback, help, and guided tutorials announce and teach each change. Owners hear about a disposition from us first, before any roadmap does.

THREE RULES OF MOTION

Converge behind the glass before consolidating in front of it.

Choose the lightest intervention that removes the friction.

Nothing is consolidated until the source is turned off.

↻ LOOP · MEASURE

Baselines captured in Discovery; outcomes measured 30 and 90 days after each wave; lessons feed the next wave. User outcomes lead, portfolio and cost measures support.

03 · SHARED LANGUAGE

Name the intervention you mean.

Most sprawl starts when a feature is funded, staffed, and branded as an application. A ratified vocabulary is the first deliverable.

RECONCILED The source documents used **convergence** in two ways. This strategy adopts the framework's spectrum: **convergence** happens behind the glass (shared platforms, data, and components); **consolidation** happens in front of it (fewer apps, sources retired).

BUILDING BLOCKS · EACH NESTS IN THE NEXT

Capability
A reusable function served by a capability platform, with no UI of its own.

Feature
A user-facing function inside an app, with no identity, navigation, or audience of its own.

Workflow
An end-to-end sequence with a trigger, hand-offs, and an outcome. The unit of analysis.

Application
A named product users launch and live in to do a primary job.

SuperApp
One shell hosting related workflows as modules for a whole role or mission domain.

THE INTERVENTION SPECTRUM · LIGHTEST TO HEAVIEST

TERM	WHAT CHANGES	WHAT THE USER SEES	APP COUNT
Standardize	Shared tokens, components, patterns	Apps look and behave alike	Same
Integrate	SSO, APIs, events, deep links	No re-keying; hand-offs carry context	Same
Federate	Apps render as modules in a shared shell	One entry point and navigation	Front ends merge
Converge	Duplicate logic moves to capability platforms	Gradual consistency, often invisible	Not directly
Consolidate	Several apps merge into one destination	Fewer apps; one place to do the work	Fewer
Retire	App turned off; data migrated or archived	A redirect to the replacement	Fewer

Seam: where a workflow crosses an app boundary.

Swivel-chair: manual transfer between apps.

Overlap: two or more apps doing one capability.

Disposition: the decision assigned to an app.

Wave: dispositions executed together.

Parity baseline: what a replacement must cover.

GUIDING PRINCIPLES

These settle disputes before they reach leadership.

01 **Mission outcomes and workflows lead.** Not the org chart or how a tool was funded.

02 **Evidence over opinion.** Ownership, tenure, and sunk cost are context, not evidence.

03 **Extend before you build.** A new application must earn its place.

04 **Lightest intervention that works.** Standardize, integrate, federate, then consolidate.

05 **Converge behind the glass first.** Merging UIs without shared platforms builds a bigger monolith.

06 **One way to do a common thing.** Shared by default, unique by exception.

07 **Users see one product family.** Moving between apps feels like moving between rooms.

08 **Better than parity, then retire.** Every consolidation removes friction and turns the source off.

09 **Standards are products, not policy.** Funded, maintained, easier to adopt than ignore.

10 **No surprises; measure what users feel.** Owners hear first. Friction, proficiency, and trust are the ends.

Close the front door. Then clear the house.

The decision ladder stops new sprawl while the disposition process removes what already exists. Without both, convergence work is undone as fast as it is done.

ENGINE 1 · PREVENT · THE DECISION LADDER

1	**Configure**	Settings, permissions, or configuration in an existing app
2	**Extend**	A feature in an app that serves the same users
3	**Compose**	A new module inside an existing SuperApp
4	**Integrate**	Connect existing apps: shared data, deep links, events
5	**Platform**	A reusable capability on a MACH1 platform
6	**New app**	Only when 1 to 5 fail and all seven criteria hold

A new app must prove all seven

Distinct primary audience · Distinct core job · Daily-use gravity · No credible home (nearest SuperApp owners agree) · Built on shared foundations from day one · Sustainment funded for the full lifecycle · Exit plan with success measures

Signals it is a feature

Same users as an existing app · Same data · Entry point is a button inside another app · Used weekly or less · Justified by speed of delivery rather than user need

ENGINE 2 · REDUCE · THE DISPOSITION TREE

Is the capability still needed?	No → **Retire**
Duplicated elsewhere? If no: do seams cause friction?	No → **Retain / Invest**
Friction exists: does integration remove it?	Yes → **Integrate** No → **Federate**
Duplicated: same users and same workflows?	No → **Converge**
Same users: does a destination exist or is one planned?	Yes → **Consolidate, then Retire** No → **Converge**

Applied per app and per capability inside it. Converge is the default for duplicates until a consolidation destination exists. Owners may appeal a Consolidate or Retire disposition once, with evidence.

Prioritization score (weights proposed for Charter)

User pain 30%	Overlap 20%	Strategic fit 20%	Cost 15%	Tech health 15%

When a SuperApp is justified ALL EIGHT, WITH EVIDENCE

1 Coherent audience. A role or mission thread, end to end.

2 Fragmentation. That audience relies on three or more apps.

3 Shared data. Modules work on the same entities.

4 Continuity. Users move work between apps within one task.

5 No existing home. Current SuperApp owners sign off.

6 Platform ready. Capabilities exist or are funded on MACH1.

7 Retirement committed. Dated decommission plan for the apps it replaces.

8 One owner. A product leader with authority over the shell.

WRONG ANSWER IF

Modules share a funding line but not users or data.

It is a portal of links rather than a unified shell.

No existing application would be retired.

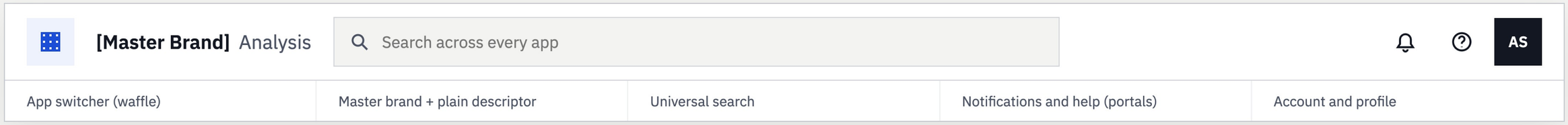
Navigation would become a menu of everything.

05 · PILLAR B · UNIFY THE EXPERIENCE

Recognize the family before reading the name.

Brand cohesion is shared behavior as much as shared appearance. One master brand carries the trust; the design system carries the language; the universal header carries the feeling of one product.

THE UNIVERSAL HEADER · SAME PLACE, SAME BEHAVIOR, EVERY APP



BRAND ARCHITECTURE

Branded house Recommended	Master brand + descriptive name. Maximizes trust and makes consolidation painless, since no product owns an independent identity.
Endorsed brands Transitional	For established legacy products while they migrate.
House of brands Retire	Today's state for many apps. The pattern this strategy ends.

Naming: [Brand] + the job, such as "[Brand] Reports". Mythological names stay with internal platforms, programs, and engineering systems; acronym-only product names retire. Renaming is sequenced with consolidation so users never learn a name about to disappear.

ONE LANGUAGE, ENCODED IN THE DESIGN SYSTEM

Icon family. One grid, shape, radius, and stroke; one glyph per app.

Color tokens. One palette, identical semantics, light and dark defined once.

Typography. One open-licensed, self-hostable family and scale.

Voice and glossary. "Share" means share everywhere, errors included.

Entry and exit moments. Sign-in, loading, email, and help styling.

Accessibility as brand. WCAG 2.2 AA is part of the promise.

Stewardship: a small brand council (UX, product, communications) approves names and icons and keeps brand assets inside the design system for teams to consume.

FROM EVIDENCE TO ENFORCEMENT · THE INTERFACE STANDARD

INVENTORY PHASE 1	INVENTORY PHASE 2	INVENTORY PHASE 3	GAP ANALYSIS	PAVED ROAD
Framework, iconography, typography, color, spacing and layout	Canonical component matrix per app	Motion, content and microcopy, data visualization, interaction and form patterns	Feeds the design system and token roadmap, brand decisions, and overlap detection	Components via Platforma; conformance checks in Nitro

06 · PILLAR C · CARRY THE CHANGE

No one learns about a change from a shutdown notice.

Portals and tutorials are the delivery system for every consolidation and rename. They also anchor the broader user enablement strategy: in-app help, product communications, training, and a unified Tier 1 to 3 help desk.

STANDARD USER PORTALS

One trusted place to learn and be heard, one click from the universal header.

Release notes
Written to a standard users understand

Roadmap
What is next, including retirements

Feedback
Visible response, measured time to reply

Help center
Current docs in one consistent style

Surfaced at the SuperApp level once apps consolidate, so the portal follows the user rather than the codebase.

IN-APP GUIDED TUTORIALS

Learning in the flow of work, on shared tooling.

- → Top-task tours for every app, shipped with each major release.
- → One tutorial standard and toolset, provided on the paved road.
- → Disconnected video creation for enablement teams in the restricted environment.
- → Cutover guidance built in, so migrating users are taught the new path at the moment they need it.

THE COMMUNICATION TRACK · RUNS BESIDE EVERY PHASE

0 CHARTER	1 DISCOVERY	2 IDENTIFY	4 DISPOSITION	5 DESIGN	7 MIGRATION	8 RETIREMENT
Program announcement: why, goals, principles, how decisions are made	Research recruitment; data-call notice; "you said, we heard"	Candidate list previewed privately with affected owners	Owners briefed one to one before the register is published	Users test prototypes; champions recruited	Notices at 30, 14, and 3 days; training; tutorials; office hours	Final notice; redirect live; public credit to the retiring team

AUDIENCES

Leadership	Progress, risks, decisions needed · monthly board brief, quarterly report
App owners and teams	Dispositions, rationale, appeal path, their role · direct engagement first
Capability platform teams	Incoming capabilities, API needs, timelines · coordination sync
End users	What changes, when, why it is better · portals, in-app, champions
Support desk	Cutover dates, known issues, redirects · runbooks, pre-cutover briefings

MANAGING RESISTANCE

The strongest resistance comes from teams whose apps retire.

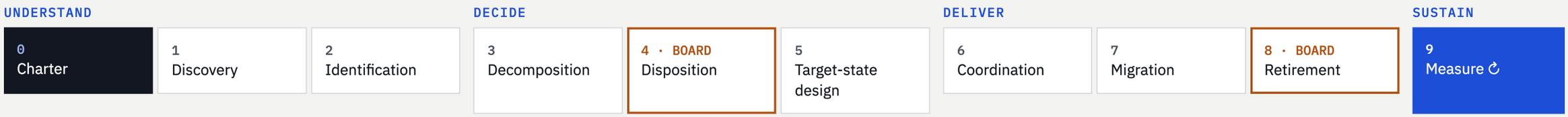
Engage early and show the evidence. Give them a real role in the destination as a stream-aligned or platform team. Credit their work publicly. An appeal path that is used, and occasionally succeeds, builds more trust than one on paper.

07 · PILLAR D · GOVERN THE WORK

Decide once, at the right table. Enforce on the paved road.

Standards without decision rights become suggestions. Portfolio decisions live inside the existing architecture review board (AERB) rather than a new body.

THE DISPOSITION PROCESS · CHARTER ONCE, THEN PHASES 1 TO 9 REPEAT PER WAVE



Every arrow is a gate. Key bars: Discovery covers 100% of in-scope apps and the workflows of 80% of users; target designs cover the parity baseline and beat it on time, seams, errors, or satisfaction; cutover needs reconciled data, pilot success at baseline, and a tested rollback; retirement needs 30 days below the usage threshold.

DECISION RIGHTS

DECISION	DECIDES	WHERE ENFORCED
New application or SuperApp	AERB	Architecture review; funding requests
Dispositions, waves, retirements	AERB, on working group proposal *	Disposition register; portfolio roadmap
Brand, naming, icons	Brand council	Design system release
Design system standards, tokens	Design system team	Nitro conformance checks; design reviews
Portal and tutorial standards	UX and user enablement	Release readiness checklist

* Reconciled: the strategy draft placed consolidation and retirement with the Technical Director under leadership approval; the framework placed all dispositions at AERB. This strategy proposes AERB, with the executive sponsor resolving cross-portfolio conflicts. Leadership to confirm.

WHO DOES THE WORK

Executive sponsor sets targets and owns the outcome. **Convergence lead** runs the process and the roadmap. A **Convergence Working Group**, led jointly by UX and architecture, works between board sessions with app owners, platform owners, the change lead, and records and security.

CADENCE AND ESCALATION

Weekly convergence sync with a RAID log. Monthly board checkpoint. Disputes go to the convergence lead within five business days, then the board, then the sponsor.

PAVED ROADS

Shared components, the universal header, portal templates, and tutorial tooling ship through Platforma, so adopting the standard takes less effort than building around it.

08 · ROADMAP

Evidence this quarter. Visible change in January.

Aligned to MACH1: the October to December foundation period sets definitions, authority, and baselines; user-facing change begins in January.

DATES PROPOSED FOR LEADERSHIP REVIEW

	H0 · OCT TO DEC 2026 **Foundation**	H1 · JAN TO MAR 2027 **First visible change**	H2 · APR TO SEP 2027 **First wave delivered**	H3 · OCT 2027 ONWARD **Scale and sustain**
A **Shape the portfolio**	Ratify lexicon and ladder. Application census. Workflow catalog, journey maps. Matrices A and B. Onboard the portfolio to Nitro and Platforma.	Wave 1 decomposition and dispositions approved. Ladder enforced at AERB. First SuperApp candidate assessed against the eight criteria.	First SuperApp shell live with federated modules. Target designs validated. Pilots, parallel runs, cutovers. First retirements.	Repeating wave cadence. Federated modules consolidate as platforms mature. Net app count trends down.
B **Unify the experience**	Interface inventory Phases 1 and 2 complete. Brand architecture and master brand decided. Naming convention drafted.	Universal header and app switcher on first apps. Design tokens v1. Icon family. Inventory Phase 3 underway.	Header on all retained apps. Content style guide and glossary. Conformance checks running in Nitro.	Motion and data visualization standards. Conformance published openly per app.
C **Carry the change**	Program announcement. Portal and release-note standards defined. Tutorial tooling selected.	Standard portals live for first apps. Wave 1 owners briefed before publication.	Top-task tutorials for wave 1 apps. Cutover notices, champions, office hours.	Portal coverage across the portfolio. Tutorials refreshed with every major release.
D **Govern and measure**	Charter signed. Sponsor named. Scoring weights ratified. Baselines set for G1 to G5.	Targets approved against baselines. Weekly sync and monthly board checkpoint running.	30 and 90 day outcome reports for wave 1. Lessons feed wave 2 Discovery.	Quarterly outcome reporting. Cost of ownership per user tracked.
GATES	**Gate 1 · end of H0.** Charter, lexicon, and baselines approved; master brand selected.	**Gate 2 · end of H1.** Wave 1 plan and first SuperApp approved by AERB.	**Gate 3 · end of H2.** First retirements recorded; 90-day outcomes beat baseline.	

Judge it by what users experience.

GOAL	LEADING INDICATOR	OUTCOME MEASURE	PILLAR
G1 Simplify the portfolio	Candidates dispositioned; waves on plan	Net app count; duplicate capability implementations (Matrix B); run cost retired	A
G2 Connect the work	Integrations delivered for priority workflows	Manual seams per workflow (Matrix A); time on task; error rate	A
G3 Unify the experience	Token and component adoption per app	% of apps conformant; cross-app SUS by persona	B
G4 Earn trust through transparency	Apps publishing through standard portals	Feedback-to-response time; user awareness of changes	C
G5 Reduce time to proficiency	Apps with top-task tutorials	Time to first successful task; Tier 1 tickets per active user	C

Baselines come from Discovery, the interface inventory, telemetry, and help desk data; targets follow once baselines exist. **Portfolio metrics are never reported without user outcomes beside them.**

KEY RISKS AND MITIGATIONS

Teams see loss of identity or funding.
Move them into stream-aligned or platform roles; credit their work.

Standards published, not adopted.
Paved-road components; AERB and pipeline enforcement; open conformance.

Consolidation without convergence.
Platforms before UI; Converge is the default until a destination exists.

A SuperApp becomes a portal of links.
Module contract and shared navigation required before launch.

Rebranding outpaces consolidation.
Sequence naming changes with disposition decisions.

Sources never actually turn off.
Retirement is a board-recorded phase with exit criteria.

Users experience disruption.
Every change through the portals with tutorials and 30/14/3-day notices.

Records or ATO constraints stall retirement.
Records and security engaged from Decomposition onward.

DECISIONS NEEDED FROM LEADERSHIP

- [ ] Ratify the shared lexicon, decision ladder, and principles as portfolio policy.
- [ ] Name the executive sponsor.
- [ ] Grant AERB authority over new apps, SuperApps, and dispositions.
- [ ] Approve the prioritization weights.
- [ ] Adopt the branded house model and select the master brand.
- [ ] Set an app-count target paired with a user-outcome target.
- [ ] Choose the first-wave population and SuperApp candidate.
- [ ] Fund the design system, portals, and tutorial tooling as products with dedicated teams.
- [ ] Confirm records and ATO constraints for data disposition and decommissioning.
- [ ] Approve the proposed roadmap and gates.